

UNIT 10 / Work, messages and your final mission

Write a short message

Your goal: Write a clear invitation or cancellation with a greeting and closing.

01 Learn the idea

A short message needs a purpose, essential details and a closing. For a friend, Hallo Mia and Viele Grüße work well. Give the day, time and place for an invitation. For a cancellation, say Ich kann heute nicht kommen and add a brief reason or an alternative plan.

Use und to add information and aber to contrast it. Keep complete clauses simple: Ich möchte kommen, aber ich muss arbeiten. Read your message as the recipient: can they tell what happens, when and where? Check names, capitals and verb endings before sending. Practise with fictional contact details.

Words and phrases

German	English
Liebe Mia,	Dear Mia,
Ich kann heute nicht kommen.	I cannot come today.
Hast du morgen Zeit?	Do you have time tomorrow?
Viele Grüße	Best wishes
Bis bald!	See you soon!

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Hallo Mia, ich kann heute nicht kommen. Ich muss arbeiten.

Hello Mia, I cannot come today. I have to work.

Mia

Kein Problem. Hast du morgen Zeit?

No problem. Do you have time tomorrow?

Ben

Ja, um sechs Uhr. Bis morgen!

Yes, at six. See you tomorrow!

Your real-life mission

Write a 30-word message cancelling a meeting and suggesting another day and time. Include a greeting, reason and closing.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Liebe Mia,” mean?

- A. I cannot come today.
- B. Do you have time tomorrow?
- C. Dear Mia,

2. What does “Ich kann heute nicht kommen.” mean?

- A. I cannot come today.
- B. Do you have time tomorrow?
- C. Best wishes

3. What does “Hast du morgen Zeit?” mean?

- A. Best wishes
- B. Do you have time tomorrow?
- C. See you soon!

4. Which connector contrasts two statements?

- A. und
- B. aber
- C. auch

5. When do they suggest meeting instead?

- A. Today at six
- B. Tomorrow at six
- C. Next Monday at nine

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - Dear Mia,

“Liebe Mia,” means “Dear Mia,”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - I cannot come today.

“Ich kann heute nicht kommen.” means “I cannot come today.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - Do you have time tomorrow?

“Hast du morgen Zeit?” means “Do you have time tomorrow?”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - aber

Aber means but and signals a contrast.

5. B - Tomorrow at six

Mia suggests tomorrow; Ben adds um sechs Uhr.

One possible mission response

Hallo Mia, ich kann heute leider nicht kommen. Ich muss arbeiten. Hast du morgen um sechs Uhr Zeit? Wir können ins Café gehen. Viele Grüße, Ben

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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